- How technically mature your team is

Adding velocity to your estimates will show you how many tasks are getting completed versus how much estimated effort you put into tasks. There should be a significant delta between the two because each task would have an estimate greater than 1 point. If your team takes on 10 tasks each with an estimate of 3 points, then your volume will be 10 and your velocity target will be 30 (10 tasks * 3 estimate points).

When you notice the delta between volume and estimation shrinking, that's usually an indication that something is wrong. Usually that means you're doing a lot of work you didn't plan for. If your task volume is 30 and your target estimate is 30, then you either have 30 tasks all estimated at 1 point or you have tasks creeping into your work stream that you never estimated. To figure out where that is coming from you'll have to dig into your data a bit more.

3.3.2. Bugs

The previous data will help you dig into your estimates to figure out how accurate they are, but there's still more data you can add to further hone your understanding. Adding bugs to the picture will give you an idea of what kind of tasks your team is working on. This is an especially important metric for teams that don't estimate bugs, because that work would have been only partially visible to you so far.

A bug represents a defect in your software, which can mean different things to different people. If a feature makes its way to done, all the necessary parties sign off on completion, and it turns out that there's a defect that causes negative effects to your consumers, you have a bug. Bugs are important to track because they point to the quality of the software your team is producing. You should pay attention to two bug trends bug creation rate and bug completion rate.

Bug creation rate can be calculated by getting the count of all of the tasks of type "bug" or "defect" by create date. Bug completion rate is calculated by